

Nathalie El-Bazzal

PhD Candidate in Economics at the University of Paris 8 | Research Affiliate at the Paris School of Economics

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[Website](#)

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Trade • Geoeconomics • Political Economy • Global Value Chains

EDUCATION

University of Paris 8, France 2026-Present

PhD Candidate in Economics

Thesis: Trade Shocks and Geoeconomic Fragmentation

Supervisor: [Professor Jamel Saadaoui](#)

University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, France 2024-2026

Pre-Doctoral Studies in Economics

Relevant coursework: Econometrics; International Trade; Applied Quantitative Methods; Firm Competitiveness; Trade and Finance

ESCP Business School, France 2020-2021

MSc in Financial Management

Thesis: Foreign Direct Investment in a Conflict Country: The Syrian Case

Sciences Po Grenoble, France 2018-2020

Master's Degree in International Relations

Middle Eastern and Mediterranean Studies

Thesis: Economic Recovery in Syria under Political Instability

University of Lille, France 2014-2018

Bachelor's Degree in Political Science

Third year at Saint Joseph University of Beirut, Lebanon, 2017-2018

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Working Paper

Trading Under Fire: Houthi Attacks and the Disruption of Global Shipping

Single-authored

Work in Progress

Geopolitics, Geoeconomics, and Politics: A Survey and Event-Classification Protocol

With [Jamel Saadaoui](#) (University of Paris 8).

Trade and Financial Frictions in Fragmented Economies

With [Pierre-Louis Vézina](#) (King's College London) and [Jean-Charles Bricongne](#) (Banque de France).

Measuring Bilateral Geopolitical Tensions

With [Jean-Charles Bricongne](#) (Banque de France), [Benoît Chaulvet](#) (University of Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne),

[Thomas Renault](#) (University of Paris-Saclay), and [Jamel Saadaoui](#) (University of Paris 8).

Research Notes

When Market Spillovers Are Not Geopolitics 2026

With [Jamel Saadaoui](#) (University of Paris 8).

How Sanctions Redraw Oil Trade Flows, 2022-2025 2026

With [Hodayoun Falakshahi](#) (Kpler).

RESEARCH GRANTS & AWARDS

CEPR ReCIPE Big Research Grant (£100,000), United Kingdom 2026-2028

Project initiated and designed; Research team coordinated

Trade and Financial Frictions in Fragmented Economies

With [Pierre-Louis Vézina](#) (King's College London), and [Jean-Charles Bricongne](#) (Banque de France).

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Paris School of Economics, France July 2026-Present

Junior Researcher

- Conduct research on international trade, geoeconomics, and geopolitical fragmentation.
- Lead the scientific coordination and day-to-day management of the CEPR ReCIPE research project.

Institute for International and Strategic Affairs - IRIS Sup' , France	2023-Present
Master's Thesis Supervisor and Project Leader	
• Supervise Master's theses in geopolitics, international trade, and development. • Supervise professional group reports on public-private partnerships, economic diversification, labor markets, and geopolitical disruptions.	
University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne , France	2025-2026
Teaching Assistant in Economics	
• Introduction to Econometrics, third-year Bachelor's level, Spring 2026. • History of Economic Thought, third-year Bachelor's level, Fall 2025.	

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026: Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC-FREIT, Alghero, Italy); **European Trade Study Group Annual Conference** (ETSG, University of Exeter, UK); **World Trade Dialogue** (Kiel Institute for the World Economy, Hamburg, Germany).

DISCUSSANT ROLES

2026: Discussant for **Geopolitical Risk and Foreign Dependence in Global Shipping**, by [Simon Fuchs](#) (Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta), [Fernando Leibovici](#) (Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis), and [Woan Foong Wong](#) (University of Oregon), at the **World Trade Dialogue**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business France - French Embassy, Cairo, Egypt 2022-2024

Trade Advisor - Industry and Cleantech

- Conducted sectoral economic analyses across energy, infrastructure, transport, water, waste management, security, and related industries.
- Advised more than 160 firms on market-entry strategies and international expansion across MENA economies.
- Organized high-level trade missions and institutional engagements across Egypt, Jordan, Tunisia, and the UAE.

Safran, Paris, France

Nov. 2021-Jan. 2022

Digital Transformation Analyst

- Conducted quantitative analysis of digital-transformation strategies and organizational performance.
- Synthesized academic literature to support strategic decision-making.

ESCP Business School, Paris, France

Sept. 2021-Feb. 2022

Research Assistant and Project Coordinator

- Coordinated research projects within the Corporate Governance and Retailing Chairs.
- Contributed to applied research on foreign-direct-investment screening and retail transformation.
- Coordinated academic collaborations with international experts.

French High School Charles de Gaulle, Damascus, Syria

2019-2020

Chief Education Advisor

- Managed academic operations and implemented strategic educational policies in a complex geopolitical environment.

Business France - French Embassy, Doha, Qatar

Sept. 2018-Mar. 2019

Trade Officer

- Conducted economic and sectoral analyses of Qatari industries and identified market opportunities for French firms.
- Contributed to the organization of the Qatar-France Business and Investment Forum.
- Supported economic exchanges and business meetings between French and Qatari partners.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Former High-Level Athlete - Wrestling 2014-2015

Silver medal, French National Championships, 2015; bronze medal, 2014; medalist in international competitions.

Delegate - ESCP Alumni MENA

March 2023-Present

Journalism Intern - Aujourd'hui la Turquie, Istanbul

July-August 2018

Founder - Public Speaking Club

2016-2020

Experience across France, Lebanon, and Qatar.

Responsible for Democratization - Sciences Po Lille

2016-2017

SKILLS

Software and Technical Skills: R, Python, Stata, LaTeX

Languages: French and Arabic (native); English (fluent)